

to your Library, you can browse by artist and genre. You can rate your music tracks, then build playlists based on such parameters as your rating, the bitrate, and more.

The “Radio” button on the left brings up Real’s Internet radio station directory. Clicking on “CD/DVD” allows you to burn a CD after adding tracks to be burnt in the main pane. While here, the Tasks pane opens up, allowing you to print a jewel case and more. There’s no DVD burning option, though.

The menu options at the top are straightforward enough. For example, the Favorites list shows you the bookmarks you’ve created—for Web pages, audio, radio and video.

Synchronisation works pretty much the same way as in Windows Media Player. Synchronization compares the content of My Library and the active (attached and selected) portable device. If the active portable device is missing any files, RealPlayer will download the necessary copies to the device. Synchronisation can be performed manually or automatically: to synchronise a device manually, select Synchronize Device from the sidebar in the Burn/Transfer page. To allow RealPlayer to automatically synchronise files, first select Change Options... from the sidebar to open the Options dialog. Next, select the Synchronization tab, and then select “Enable automatic synchronization...” Thereafter, whenever a portable device is attached to your computer and RealPlayer is running, RealPlayer will synchronise My Library with the device.

Help happens to be both online and offline: some items in the Help window will only show up if you’re online.

RealPlayer, like Winamp, is skinnable—there is a default set of skins available, and you can download additional skins. Similarly, there is a default set of visualisations, and you can download more.